



Programmable bacteria

Bacterial colonies programmed with synthetic genes can assemble microscopic gold particles into devices, a new study finds. <http://digit.in/ProgBact>



Wind energy to power a civilization

A study states that there's so much potential wind energy over oceans, it could generate "civilization scale power". <http://digit.in/unlimpower>

rum (WIEF) seeks startups currently in product development or beta rollout stage, with an investment or revenue of not more than \$1M. What's more, the startup doesn't have to be based out of India, although the product must be targeted at the Indian market.

Along with prizes of more than \$20,000 awarded on pitch day, two



winners also get pro-bono legal advice from Wharton India's legal partners and access to Wharton entrepreneurs and industry experts for mentorship. Along with that, the top 10 teams get to pitch their business ideas to conference attendees, sponsors, and a global media audience, while the top 20 startups are invited to WIEF Conference (Mumbai) to interact with investors and conference attendees as part of a formal startup exhibit. This gives them a lot of exposure, something that is crucial for upcoming startups to be noticed by investors and market leaders. Along with the ones mentioned above, this competition has seen the likes of Haptik, Zoomcar and Flintobox among its competitors as well. Although, with more than 500 startups applying each year, the competition is in no way easy – but then again, what good thing comes easy?

G-STARTUP WORLDWIDE, BENGALURU EDITION

G-Startup Worldwide is a global startup competition held around the world to find the most innovative, early stage startups, invest \$1,000,000 in them, support them with a global network and enable them to change the world. But to actually qualify for the global competition, you have to first participate in a regional edition. For India, that would be the Bengaluru edition,

to be held this year on November 15-16.

For any regional edition of the competition, the top 10 finalists get a bunch of benefits. For instance, they get the opportunity to pitch locally to VCs as well as opportunity to be a part of FbStartup from Facebook. But that's just the beginning. A select few regional winners also get

- \$50,000 investment prize
- 1 Year G-Network Membership
- \$5,000 Ad credits by FbStart from Facebook
- Complimentary trip to Silicon Valley (up to \$1000 flight + 3 nights hotel) to pitch at the Global Final Competition and more.

If they win the global competition, that's an additional \$250,000 in



investment. Just the overall investment of \$300,000 should be enough motivation to compete in this one. While global alumni like App Annie and DiDi Chuxing are quite significant, one look at the top 15 at GMIC Bangalore 2016, with rising names such as Confrmkt and SmartVizX, shows that the Indian edition is no less.

CONQUEST, CEL - BITS PILANI

While the previous names in this article might have heavyweight organisations and huge prize money pools to boast of, Conquest has something more unique than that - it is by students and for students. Don't let that discourage you about the benefits though - on top of the direct prizes of INR 4 lakh given to the top two startups as equity less funding, there are benefits up to \$1Million to be

won at the competition.

The contest was started back in 2004 as a business plan competition, and eventually it grew with the startup ecosystem to evolve into the startup competition that it is today. Another unique aspect of this competition is



the mentoring system that is followed, which allows startups to be connected to mentors for guidance during the competition. The mentors comprise of some of the most significant names from the Indian startup investment ecosystem, as well as startup executives themselves from big names like Oyo Rooms, Haptik, Zomato, Practo and more. While this year's edition is done, you can stay tuned to <http://conquest.org.in/> for updates about next year.

E-SUMMIT 2017

Organised by the entrepreneurship cell of IIT Bombay, E-Summit is a comprehensive event that comprises of a number of useful sub-sections for startups and aspiring entrepreneurs. The event, overall, is targeted at students looking to make it big with their idea. As a part of the event, you can enter 'The Ten Minute Million', a startup competition where startups selected from a pool of registrants can get a chance to pitch their idea in front of investors with chances of investment going as high as INR 1.5 million.



The judging panel comprises of an impressive roster of investors from across India.

Apart from this, the event itself comprises of workshops and competitions with the objective of helping startups improve their idea and entrepreneurs hone their skills. Not a bad place to be for aspiring startups.